The Fall of Rackspace: How Friends and Family Failed the Cloud

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Abstract

Companies that get acquired try to shed their former selves and are sometimes successful. Other times, in this case with Rackspace, it became an abysmal failure. This is a personal journey through my tenure at Rackspace. Starting with a sudden change of job responsibilities to the quagmire that was the EPS project for PCI compliance, we take a look at all the pitfalls that took place during this period and what lead to them. We will examine the human actors that played their roles in the shift this organization took from being Friends and Family to what it is today, a shell of its former self.

Introduction

It was October 3, 2014, when I received an email from Laurena Mitchell that was destined to change my life. The title: **Let's Talk!** I had sent my resume the previous day through Stack Overflow (a website where many developers help each, also known as the developer's Bible site) so I was a bit surprised that I had received this email so quickly. I was 31 years old, working at a company that I had loved dearly. I recently was promoted to Software Architect, one of the two that existed at this company, and had spent four great years working with some of the best people on earth. The problem was that this promotion given to me was done so because I had no place to go. I was a QA Engineer (still am today) but the only one in the company. This email Laurena sent me was the beginning of a journey that landed me in San Antonio, TX. Little did I know that Rackspace would be, at best, a two-year engagement.

My time at Rackspace was special in many ways, and it helped me grow as both a person and as an employee, but there were many hurdles and obstacles in my way that, eventually, became too much to handle. In this account we will see what happened from day one. We will view how the job description did not match the reality of the position, how teams crumbled under unreasonable pressures, the failures of motivating teams, the unclarity of expectations, and finally my departure from the organization. It's a personal journey that I hope the reader will gain some insight into how the world of software development can be both a blessing and a curse.

Job Description and Matching

In the beginning, there was a meeting. The meeting must have happened before my tenure at Rackspace, so I do not have the exact details of my job description, but I can superimpose some of my experience with this process since I have interviewed many people and

have given input on job descriptions in previous positions. Meetings were set on how to write a detailed job description so that we can find the right person. To achieve this, we use the General Model of Job Design (see Figure 1) (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). Simply put, we take in three aspects of what we want with a new position (Design, Individual, and Social Setting). These three aspects then gave us a perceived job content which we can then infer how we can measure job performance. We'll be looking at the job design and how we determined performance, and some of the pitfalls that exist in the software industry

Job Design

When looking at creating a new position, you'd need to look at the range and depth of the job that will be performed, with range being the number of tasks performed and depth being the amount of discretion given to the potential new employee on how to achieve goals (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). When I was at another employer I was in charge of creating job descriptions for people being hired on to assist me. There were two things I needed more than anything else, the ability to code what needed to be coded (technical) and the ability to take a task and run with it. This was just the beginning. I had to sit down and understand what the typical work day of my potential employee would go through, and I had to be honest with the description. If not, I wouldn't find the right candidates for the job. Then there is the balance of technical and soft skills needed. This position I built was in a company where 95% of the employees barely understood how to turn on a computer. I remember interviewing a person who was great for the job, a professional developer with years of experience in the tools we had and the technical chops that made me look like a code boot camp graduate. The big issue was his

interpersonal skills. He did not have them at all. We had to pass because he did not meet the social aspect the job needed.

Rackspace hired me on as an SDET II (Software Development Engineer in Test Level 2). The job description was entirely technical, what it took to be successful with the role, and languages I should know (Ruby, Selenium, Cucumber). That was the job I signed up for, yet when after three months it shifted towards a leadership role with little to no software development, managing manual testers in India and here. The problem with this is that I did not have any managerial experience, and I continued to make errors along the way. Within a year in this role, I decided to seek another position in the company, more akin to what I was on the original job description, and fortunately, I did just that. It took a year to get to a job role that was more alike to the one described in the beginning. I failed at my first leadership role because I was not experienced enough to handle ten engineers, and I did not get the guidance needed to become successful. No follow-up on role changes can cause chaos.

Team Building and Its Follies

My first day on the job was on November 10, 2014. I had driven over 1000 miles in 24 hours just days before, so I wasn't in my prime. Still, I was very energetic and excited to join a new team. We had our Day One orientation in a secluded room, where they gave us our devices and went over our paperwork. Once done, we went out to meet our new teams. I was assigned to the Global Sales and Contracting Systems team (GSCS for short). Little did I know this would be the team from hell.

Joining the team

Forming

I had joined the team as their new SDET and was in charge of getting their automation efforts back on par. I worked with a team in India, who had created the original framework. We started a new contract together, agreeing on meetings, how sprint schedules would look, and overall what the goal was. We wrote a single overarching goal for ourselves, which was simple. "Attain 80% Coverage for UI Automation in one year's time." This was more than attainable as the UI for this product was not overly complicated. A gale force wind came after that initial month of overviews, product testing, and architecture.

Storming

I started noticing problems when simple deadlines were not met by my colleagues overseas. Dates slipped, the code wasn't pushed, and what was pushed wasn't of quality. In fact, it was some of the worst code I had ever seen in my life. I then noticed that half of the overseas team would not join up on meetings. Eventually, I asked what was happening, and the manager over at Chennai said that the developers were not happy that the framework was being re-written. A more experience self would have calmly explained to them that this directive was coming from higher up than me (they saw me as a team leader, to which I kept insisting I was not). They rebelled and never coded what was needed. Eventually, all tasks were put on me, and the overseas team worked on their framework, the one that did not work at all.

At this point, I would love to say that we achieved Norming and Performing, but we did not. After months of trying to get work done, I was re-assigned to another responsibility, that of

unofficial lead for the manual testers (both onshore and offshore). This started the whole stages again, but eventually, we achieved norming (but not without many conflicts).

The New Role

My manager started to become more absent as the weeks progressed, to the point where tasks needed to be done and the GSCS manager (which was part of a different organization, but still part of the team) started to look at me for answers. I hadn't been in a leadership role before, so I tried what I could. I had about five onshore testers and 8 offshore testers that were unofficially answering to me. The following 9 months in this role was pure hell. I was under a lot of stress and pressure to get our testing done faster than we could, neglecting our automation suite in favor of quick results. It got the point where, after one of our releases failed, I took the five other testers and scolded them about the testing effort. I shouldn't have done this, and in retrospect this was possibly the worst moment of my career thus far.

Leadership

Gallup Research interviewed more than 20,000 leaders, 10,000 followers, and 50 years of Gallup Polls and they came up with three key findings (Rath & Conchie, 2008):

- Leaders invest in strengths
- Leaders surround themselves with competent people
- Leaders understand their followers needs

Using this as the base for evaluating my leadership style during 2014, I would say that I failed in each aspect of leadership. Starting with strengths, Rackspace had us all run through the Strengths Finders exercise. At the time, I thought it was just trivial, but eventually, when I read the bloody thing, I found that I had not invested in my strengths, let alone my unofficial

followers. I also did not surround myself with competent people, but not because there was a lack of them, to begin with. Instead, I did not identify them and trust in their abilities. Finally, I did not listen to my followers. They were overworked and stretched to their limits, and I kept pushing which was wrong of me. If any pushing was to be done, it should have been me pushing back to management and informing them that what they were asking was the impossible. Leadership is an adamant, and it takes much practice, studying, and especially mentorship to get to where you want to be in that role.

Diversity

I want to diverge a little bit and focus on a topic that is very hot in the STEM fields. When we discuss diversity in the workplace, we deal with more than just diversity of thought. There are two types of diversity that we deal with. The first is the Primary definitions of diversity, which include age, ethnicity, gender, physical, race, and sexual orientation (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017) . According to the US Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, “Compared to overall private industry, the high-tech sector employed a larger share of whites (63.5 percent to 68.5 percent), Asian Americans (5.8 percent to 14 percent) and men (52 percent to 64 percent), and a smaller share of African Americans (14.4 percent to 7.4 percent), Hispanics (13.9 percent to 8 percent), and women (48 percent to 36 percent).” (US Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, 2016). With these numbers public, many see the tech industry in dire need for diversity, but how can this be achieved?

Secondary Attributes and their Affects

There is a perception out there that the tech industry, notably when a former Google developer, James Damore, published his infamous Google Memo, is very liberal. In it, he states that there are deep biases within Google regarding diversity, where the focus is not on how to improve this issue in the long run and work with scientific knowledge of how people work but instead shoehorning in diversity at the cost of merit (Damore, 2017). One of the controversial passages was "Women on average show a higher interest in people and men in things" (Damore, 2017), which he later clarifies solutions like "We can make software engineering more people-oriented with pair programming and more collaboration." (Damore, 2017). So, as you can see, diversity in the tech industry is a hot topic and very difficult to overcome without someone getting fired for sharing ideas.

Without delving too deep into the second order of diversity (the changeable attributes like marital status, educational background, faith, health, and experience), the tech industry has become sort of an echo chamber for political views. Lincoln Network conducted an anonymous online survey of 387 employees across different companies, and they found that people who are conservatives are afraid to be found out and ostracized (Fischer, Johnson, & Ginn, 2018). So how do we work with people who feel this way because of their secondary attributes?

At Rackspace, we had a peer review of sorts that we rated our managers and the company as a whole. In one of our meetings, we went through the diversity policy of Rackspace. In it was an African American, a person who was gay, a trans woman, and myself being Hispanic. During this meeting, the trans woman complained that there was not enough diversity in the company. We and I spoke up, stating that the room discussion was led by a woman and that we all were

diverse in our ways. In fact, Rackspace (like all tech companies) go out of their way to diversify, but to some, that was not enough. The trans woman said that they felt marginalized because there were not enough trans people in the company. The number of trans people, as of 2016, was around 0.58% of the US Population (approximately 1.3 Million people), with Texas accounting for 125,350 people (Flores, Herman, Gates, & Brown, 2016). While this number wasn't common knowledge at the time, this person was told that finding trans people is hard but always a priority. That priority always bothered me since merit gave way to an external attribute. In acknowledging this, and placating the person who said we lacked diversity (while in a room with someone who was gay, someone who was African American, and someone was Hispanic) Rackspace had capitulated to the wills of one person, to accommodate less than one percent of the population.

Eventually, we did hire another trans person, and while I did not work with them, personally they only lasted about three months before being let go due to lack of technical knowledge. Diversity is a great tool to have, as long as it does not become the sole focus of the organization and puts blinders on abilities.

Perception – Noise, Workplace, and Virtualization

Rackspace is a cavalcade of noises, people, and styles. One can spend their whole career studying the work habits of a Racker and the work environment. The Perceptual Process, as seen in figure 2 shows how work environment stimuli, such as managerial style, noise, and compensation plans, can affect the individual as they try to parse it through observation, selection, and translation (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). It determines the action based off of the apparent cause. One example would be how an employee handles a task given to

them by their manager. What needs to be completed? are there any external causes that might prevent completion of a function, and when is this is needed so I can prioritize correctly? These responses are what can make or break an employee.

The Open Work Environment

One of the hottest trends to destroy the tech industry is the open workspace. The original intention was to have more open collaboration between engineers. For a company, open plans lower costs, maxes space, and makes transparency into work easier (Kaufman, 2014). No walls also mean you can quickly talk to engineers. According to Lindsey Kaufman at the Washington Post, “about 70 percent of U.S. offices have no or low partitions.” (Kaufman, 2014). At one point, this was a point of pride for some companies, even going so far as adding them in the job posting. While most companies still have this floorplan, “many workers in open offices are frustrated by distractions that lead to poorer work performance.” (Kaufman, 2014).

Rackspace has an open workplace and the distractions, ranging from co-workers interrupting your thoughts to and work, was one of the main reasons I went to an entirely virtual work environment. As a developer, there is ramp-up time to productivity, with the average time being 23 minutes (Hendricks, 2017). In an open workspace that happens more that is acceptable, which leads to delays on the company’s dime. One of the jobs of a Rackspace manager is to manage distractions to employees, being a blocker for anyone who comes. Their blocking attempts were not always possible, and people would, quite literally, sneak around the back of our area just to come to talk to us. The number of times I had to stop work to help someone was astounding, and a primary driver towards the virtualized workplace. In fact, Nicholas Bloom from Harvard Business Review states “One-third of the productivity increase, we think, was due

to having a quieter environment, which makes it easier to process calls." (Bloom, 2014). Bloom later states "The other two-thirds can be attributed to the fact that the people at home worked more hours. They started earlier, took shorter breaks, and worked until the end of the day. They had no commute." (Bloom, 2014). As a developer, I have personally found that the lack of distractions, coupled with more time allotted without a commute, has made my productivity way higher than expected. There are drawbacks in the social aspects of work, but there are ways around it through chat rooms at the workplace to replace the water cooler, and video conferencing software for meetings. All in all, virtualized workplaces are better than what Rackspace had offered (and they were adamantly against remote work).

Virtual Work and Attendance

While not a topic directly related to Rackspace's failings, I do want to touch on the subject of attendance at a virtual workplace, and the stresses it can cause. As stated earlier by Bloom, since I do not have a commute or breaks, I work long hours. There is another issue with overwork. I try to work eight to nine hours a day but find myself reaching ten to eleven. Since there is no separation of work and home (or if there is it is thinly veiled) you can potentially have a coworker contact you and request that you log in at any time of the night. There have been many evenings where work would need something when I was technically off, but I was near my computer. There are other times where I would be sick, but since I couldn't get anyone infected, I would work in bed. There are plenty of ways you can fix this, but one of the entry points for many remote jobs is experience working remotely. It can be taxing for social butterflies, and hard for those with difficulties focusing.

The Decline of Rackspace Values

One of Rackspace's most ardent values is "Treat Rackers like Friends and Family" (Rackspace, n.d.). The following will be more personal experience than hard evidence of how a company culture changed post acquisition.

The Beginning

When I flew into San Antonio to interview for the position in question, I was thrown back by how massive the company was. Most of my career have been in mom-and-pop operations, so no sizeable corporate feel. I remember coming into the Rackspace Headquarters (then called the Castle). My recruiter showed me around, explained the company culture, and fed me Rudy's BBQ for the first time (cream corn and brisket). The fanatical support, the transparency, the Friends and Family…these all were values I believed in and wanted to be a part of and excel in. For the first year and a half, all the problems I had with teams and open workspace were all forgiven because I had been treated like I was either a friend (to people I didn't work with closely) or family (by my co-workers). It drove me to be a better employee and to work harder. Friends and Family changed in August 2016.

Apollo Management Acquisition

The real issues began about eight months before. We had our first set of layoffs in a long time, with all our manual testers being let go. Some close friends were let go, and I started to notice a sea of fear come over the company. Shortly after this set of layoffs I moved over to what was called the CORE team, working as a developer on their backend. Rumors started to float around about acquisitions and bankruptcy. People were getting antsy, and previous friends and family started to go silent, or worse go into business for themselves. I laid my head down and

focused on the work at hand, and on August 26, 2016, we were told we would be acquired by Apollo Management (Brunson, 2016). This shook the employees to the core, and the gradual decline of Friends and Family started to become a freefall. No longer were we cordial and friendly. We were now all suspicious of each other and concerned for our own hides. I left the company in January 2017, about 4 months after the acquisition was announced. The rest of the story comes from friends who stuck around until the bitter end.

The Death of Friends and Family

At Rackspace, there was one constant, Racker time. This meant that while we were supposed to be at our seats from 8-5, most of us had come in later or earlier adjust for more easy schedules. Others would split their days with half in office and half at home (because of kids). I noticed that after the acquisition managers were starting to reel in these perks, going as far as reprimanding people for being a minute or two late. A close friend, who will remain anonymous, confided in me that he had been written up several times just because he left early to pick up their kid from school. He came in earlier, per previous perks, but that no longer was the case. Shortly after those reprimands, he found a different position with a remote company that was more accommodating to his schedule. One other friend told me that his manager was timing his arrival to the minute and questioning whether they were in office or not, regardless of prior agreements. This radical change of behavior from the organization lead to most of my colleagues no longer working there. There is a current brain drain there, and it isn’t just with the change of values.

Locus of Control Post Acquisition

The months leading up to the announcement of the acquisition was very rough psychologically for everyone. Rackers left, and right was feeling the pressures of externalities. After the purchase, most rackers decided they have enough. They took what little control they had externally and internalized it by leaving Rackspace. At Rackspace, if you didn't come early, there would be no shaded parking, and you would have to park on the roof of the garage or the regular, sunbaked, parking. My friend, who is now a former employee, stated that he could find parking if he came in at noon and that the office was a lot more silent. I had started noticing the change in management style and took control of my destiny by leaving as soon as I could. I moved to San Antonio solely for Rackspace because I believed in them and their mission. Their transparency was gone, and so was I.

Organizational Change

Kurt Lewin's Three Stage Model for Organizational Change consists of letting go of the past, encouraging employees to change their attitudes and behaviors, and locking that in for the future (see figure 3) (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). In all aspects, Apollo Management was trying to do this by changing the management structure, the divisions within the company, and guided leadership towards new goals. The problem with their attempt was that they kept the old values. If you go to Rackspace's website (in the bibliography under Rackspace) you will see that the values are the same, so employees are being told that there is no difference in the changing of the guard. This was not the case. If we look at this model, the first step is to let go of the old ways. If Apollo were honest with their employees, they would have made them know that Friends and Family were not feasible for what they were trying to accomplish. In fact,

another company in San Antonio (and a former subsidiary of Rackspace) said that their values since leaving Rackspace no longer included Friends and Family. Besides values, Apollo changed certain aspects of their compensation that drove people out the door fast.

Herzberg Post Acquisition

The Herzberg Two Factor Theory is fairly simple to comprehend. There are two factors that help with motivation, hygiene (dissatisfiers) and motivators (satisfiers) (see *figure 4*) (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). Hygiene can be seen as Pay, Status, Security, Work Conditions, and Benefits, while motivators are your sense of accomplishment and meaning, as well as recognition for your hard work and increased responsibilities (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017). Post Apollo Acquisition, everything went haywire.

Hygiene

Before acquisition, Rackspace tried its best to pay according to national standards for the job. While they couldn't do that always, they did have a quarterly bonus structure that made up for it (based off of company performance). When Apollo took over, the bonuses were stopped. To some, this was the money that made up for the lower salary. This was the last straw for them and they left for higher paying jobs. At one point, I contemplated going back to Rackspace, and since I had more experience I requested more money. Instead they told me that I would have to come back for the same pay as I left, and that the bonus structure wasn't finalized and frozen until it was. I politely declined to come back.

Job Security was also thrown out the window after the company reduced its footprint by 6% in 2017 (with a second round of layoffs happening again in 2018) (Mosbrucker, 2018). It's common to be laid off in the tech industry. I have only been laid off once before, but the

psychological toll stuck with me ever since. Before I left there were rumors going around the grapevine regarding the layoffs, and as soon as this was viral people started jumping ship before the first rounds (I left before the first major layoffs happened). This lead to a culture of fear and work conditions which made for a lack of productivity.

Motivators

It was March of 2017, and Rackspace was running hard to meet PCI compliance, which meant we could process credit cards. I was on a project called EPS which allowed for reporting of account information from CORE to all other systems. My team worked tirelessly, working weekends and overnight. The deadline was tight, but we were given some carrots to chase such as free time off (for every weekend day worked, get two days off), recognition from on top, and possible promotions. We made the deadline (which was a hard date on May 31st) but got no benefits from it. In fact, it wasn't until I talked to the VP of our department before leaving that I found out these promises were not supposed to be given to us. The carrot was a lie. I had informed my former team since they were anticipating substantial rewards (even though it had been six months since the project was completed). They were both unsurprised and apathetic. At that point they were going through the motions, waiting for the day Rackspace would give them the pink slip. Motivators at Rackspace were a lie, but a well-hidden lie. There was a program called Racker-U which was supposed to help people with their goals by teaching them skills like management and coding. This too was a façade.

Stress, Stressors, and the Folk Who Brought Them

Revisiting the PCI project, my teammates and I were under a considerable. In less than two months we had to re-write a whole system from one language (ruby) to another (python)

while keeping the API (application program interface) contracts the same, down to the order of line items. This period was hard, but we made the best of it. Looking at the stress model (See Figure 5), I will demonstrate how every stressor affected us and what came out of it (Ivancevich, Konopaske, & Matteson, 2017).

Stressors

Individual

During February 2016 I was assigned to the EPS project. At this time, no priority was given, and since I was the resident Ruby expert, they thought that I could help a co-worker, Michael Coupland (Coopy) in developing this. I've always been honest to a fault, so during a meeting near the end of February Coopy had misrepresented that percentage complete, stating we were a third of the way through when in reality we were at best five percent. I had kept quiet in the meeting seeing that I was the new guy, but I had an ethical dilemma come over me, which caused the initial stresses. After talking with my mentor, Trinabh, I concluded that I had to tell the management team the truth. This was when all hell broke loose.

I was a pawn in some sick game the management team was playing. After informing the management about the issue, they had put two other people on the EPS project (my mentor and another person who eventually became a friend). They pulled Coopy off the project and finally fired him. They knew he was not going to be successful on this project, but they wanted a reason to get him out. This weighed heavily on my chest for months and changed my whole perspective of Rackspace in general.

The project was being done at a breakneck pace, with no breaks allowed. We were stuck in a 10x5 office for two months straight and eventually we gained a fourth. Communication was

a disaster, no specifications for the project besides “It had to have the same output” and no real manager in sight. We worked hard as a team, and it showed.

Group

At first, it was 3 of us in that 10x5 room. Then two more came, and it was cramped. Management was running around like a chicken without their head, making promises they bloody well knew they couldn’t keep. After six weeks of complaining we were moved to a larger space, but even then, it felt like we were at each other's throats. We tried our best to make fun of the situation, making jokes about the dumbest things, and going to lunch on the company dime. If we were revisiting the stages of creating a group, I would say we met each one. Storming was rough, but we got past it, and eventually, we were going at a fast pace putting out code faster than we thought was even possible. In the end, we were fatigued and were looking forward to the lie that was comp time.

Organizational

At the time, we did not know why we had to go so fast (besides the mandate of being PCI compliant). Later we found out that for us to be enticing to Apollo Management Group we were supposed to be PCI compliant or they would back out from the deal. The whole company was in chaos during this time, every department had their EPS project going on, and within one quarter we had upgraded damn near every system in the company. The organization, as a whole, was stressed because without Apollo’s buy out they did not see a future for Rackspace at all. In retrospect, you cannot blame them for trying this out, but it burned many bridges across all teams.

Nonwork

During this hellacious period, I had gotten married. On May 29, 2016, I married my wife, and what was supposed to be the happiest time of our lives turned into a delay for the most joyous time in our lives. We had gotten married and immediately after the wedding I had to report to work. I promised my wife that after this was all done, we would go on our honeymoon (which we did) but it did come with a cost. Our marriage started on a rocky footing, but eventually, we got the boat back on course. After the PCI race with EPS, we booked our honeymoon to Las Vegas in August. When we came back, a whole new set of stressors came when we read that there was a buyout.

Outcomes

Behavioral

I won't sugarcoat the behavioral outcomes of this time period. A lot of people left during and after PCI. There was a project, Valkyrie, that had all its developers leave during PCI compliance and the last developer that was attached after they left also quit. People were flippant at one another, and you could see the crumbling of Friends and Family begin at this point. Something foul was in the air, and it was only going to get worse. Our manager, who was instrumental in making our lives even worse than it was, came under fire for not blocking for us properly and allowing everyone and their parents to come bother us during PCI. He was eventually let go, but if there was one main reason I left it was because he did not lead us at all, instead relegating himself to coffee with friends.

Cognitive

When you are working so hard towards a goal, things tend to slip up. One of the significant outcomes was due to a poor decision we made with the rewrite. We wanted to make sure that the XML output was written correctly, but the performance of this was never tested thoroughly. EA, our biggest client, ran into issues retrieving some of their billing info which caused a severity one issue. If we had more time to design the XML output we would have quickly caught this before it hit production. It frustrated us that this was what failed.

Physiological

Full disclosure, I have Crohn's Disease. It's an autoimmune disease that targets the body's colon. During this time, I had horrible flare-ups, to the point where I could not even get out of bed without feeling pain. I couldn't rest, however, since we were on such a tight timeline, and I could not work remotely since it was denied time and time again. It got to the point that I had to take a week off after we released to recuperate from my health issues. This was a very rough period both physically and emotionally.

My Last Day

I had interviewed a couple of companies before, even going so far as having a job offer from Frost Bank, but none of them gave me everything I wanted. Eventually, I joined Carbon Black, which is another evaluation for another time. I remembered when I accepted and when I finally was able to move on. January 13, 2017, could not come any sooner. I had been at Rackspace for a bit over two years, and I saw the death of a company's culture. I had first-hand experience in what not to do as a leader, having been thrown in that position. I had grown as a person and learned from as many mistakes as I could. If Rackspace taught me one thing, it was

never to trust that a company will never change. No matter how beautiful a rose is; eventually it will wither away.

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Figures

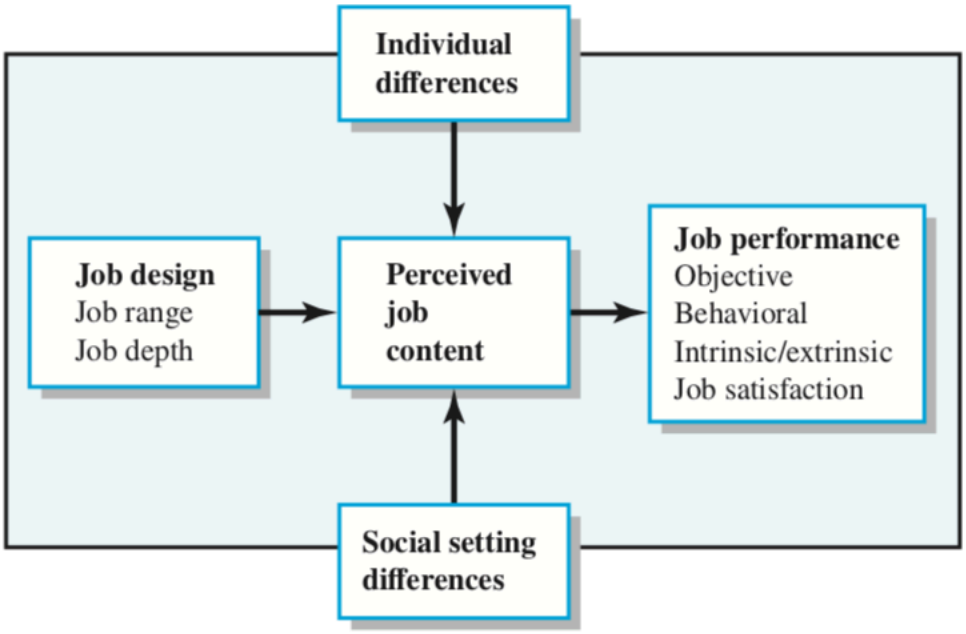

Figure 1. The General Model of Job Design

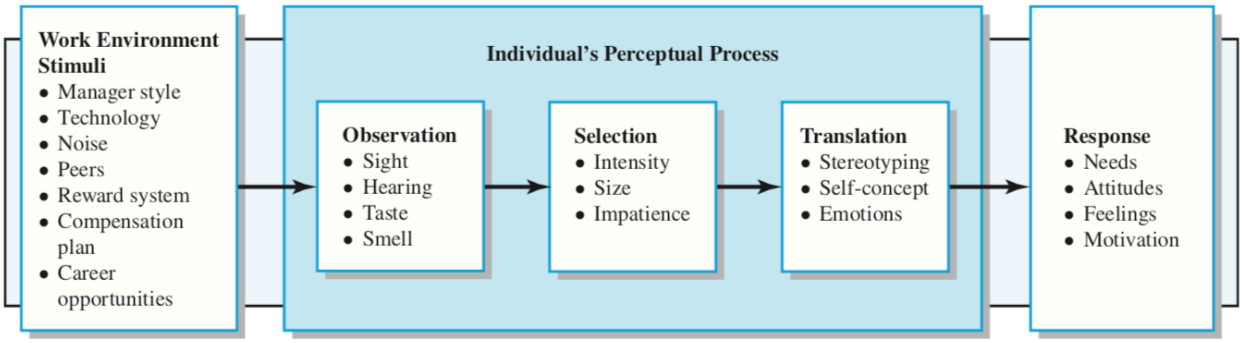

Figure 2. The Perceptual Process

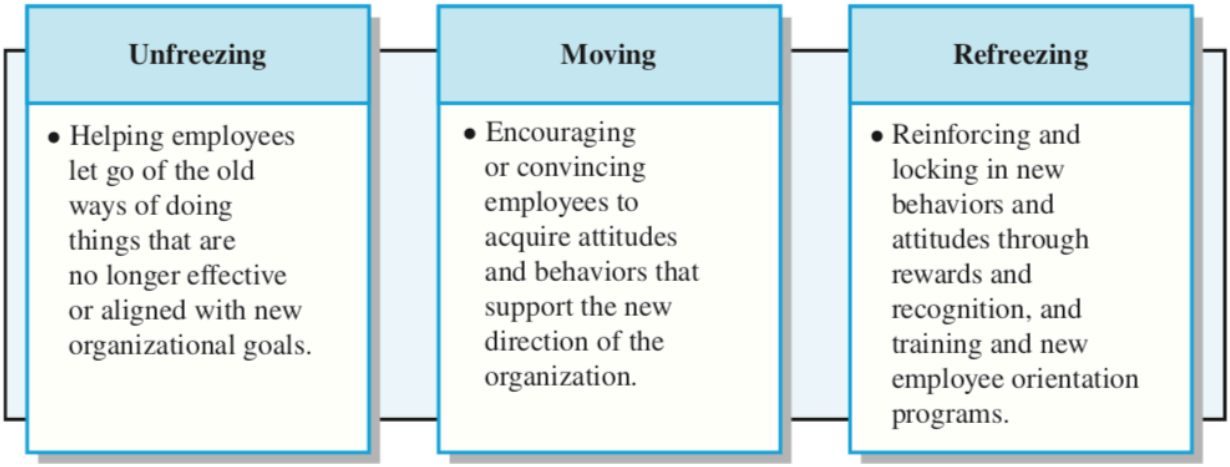

Figure 3. A General Model of Organizational Change

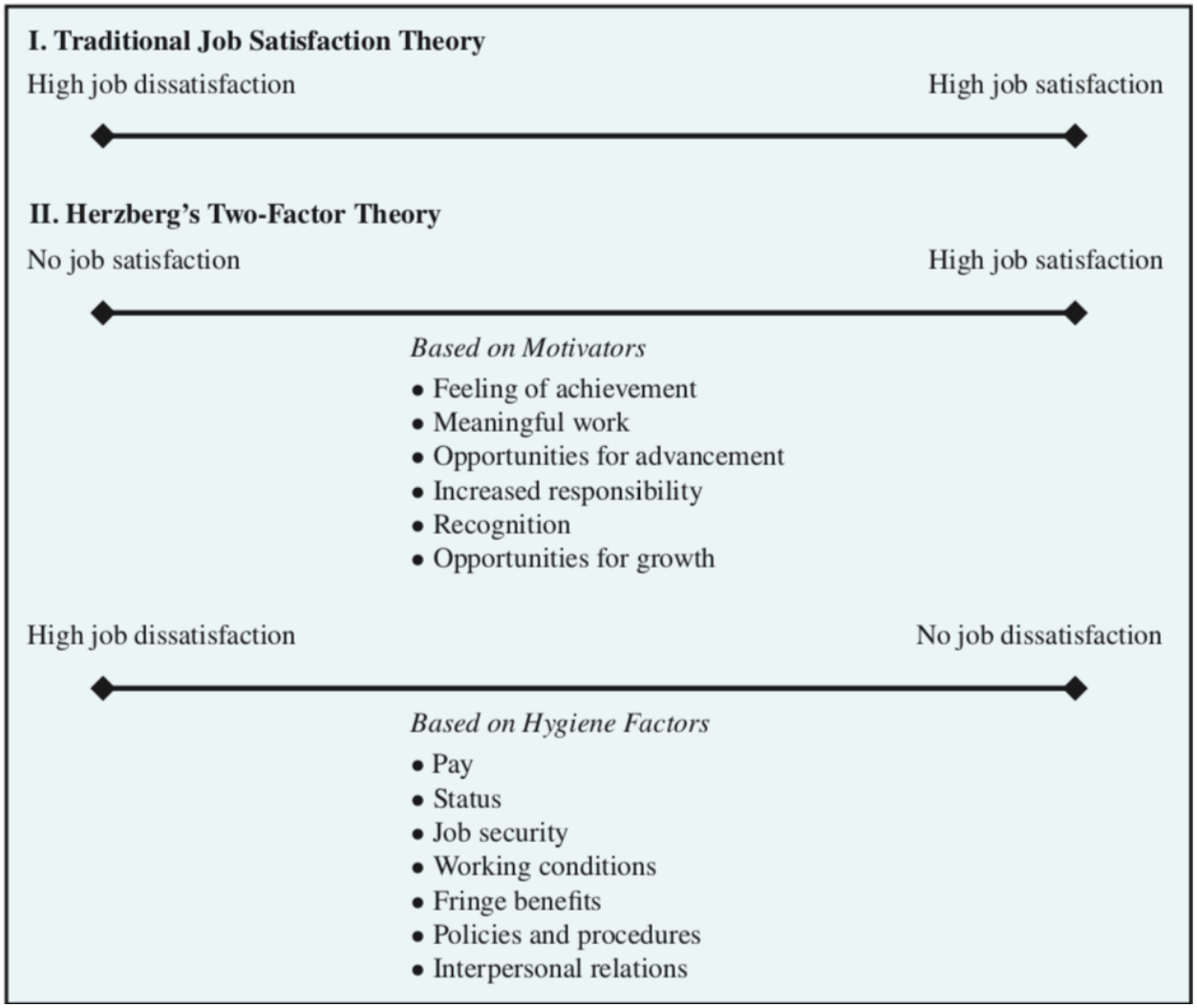

Figure 4. Herzberg View of Job Satisfaction

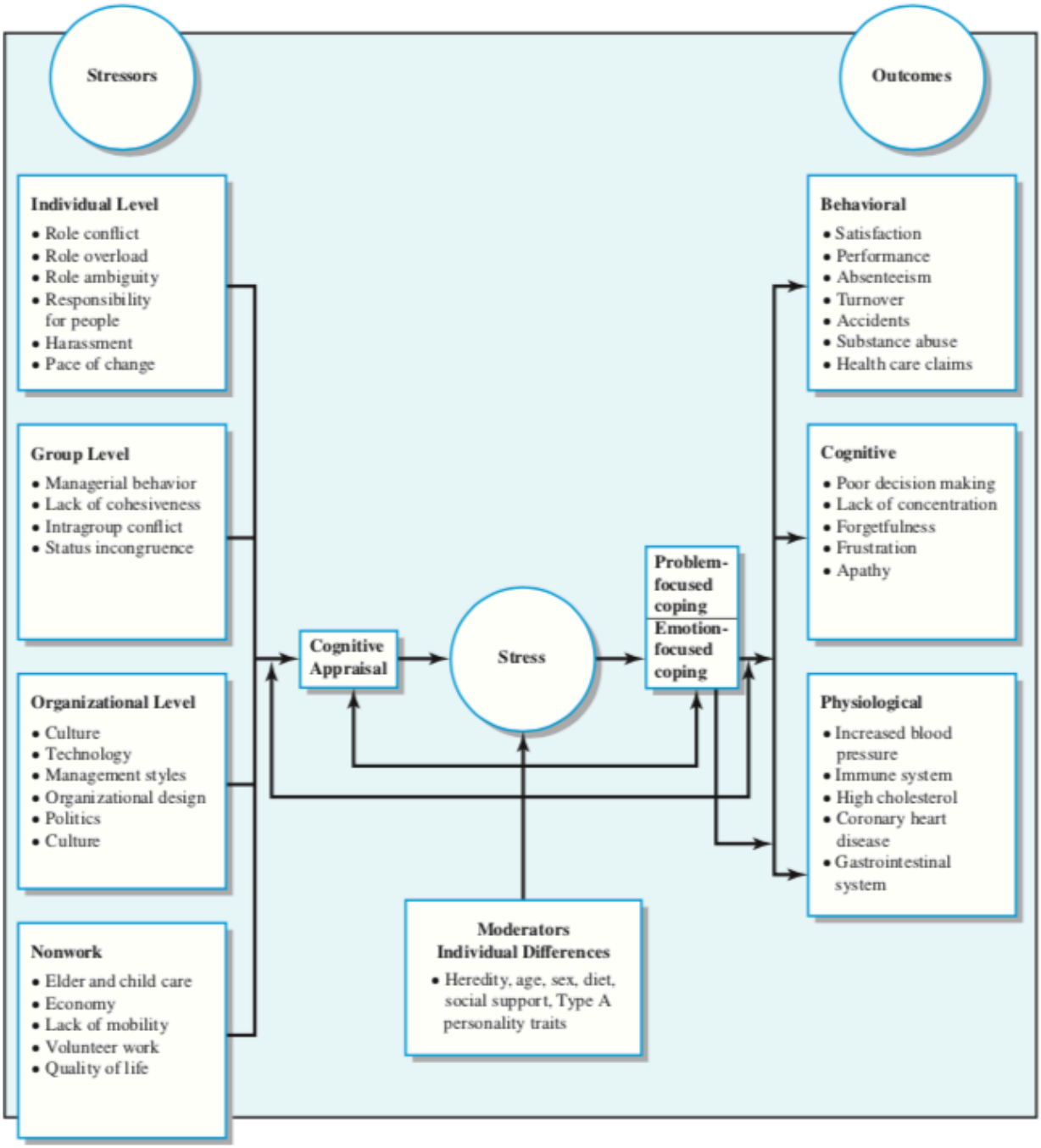

Figure 5. Stressors Model